

A Hymn to the Omniscient Great Lord

Sarvajñamahāśvarastotra · Toh 1111 · Derge Tengyur

ཐམས་ཅད་མཁུ་པ་དབང་པུ་གྲུ་

Toh 1111 in the Tengyur is a devotional hymn in Sanskrit known as the Sarvajñamahāśvarastotra, rendered in Tibetan as Thamché Khyenpa Wangchuk, meaning "A Hymn to the Omniscient Great Lord." It is a stotra, or praise poem, addressed to a supreme lord described in terms that blend Buddhist and Śaiva imagery — honoring a being who is a god beyond gods, the guru of gurus, the burner of the three cities, and the bearer of a skull — evoking the figure of Śiva recast within a Buddhist devotional framework. The text belongs to the broader category of hymns and praises found in the Tengyur. According to its colophon, no Indian commentary was available to the translators, and the work was completed at the monastery of glorious Sakya by the Śākya monk Kunga Gyaltsen Palzangpo.

Not having found an Indian commentary, this was later completed at the monastery of glorious Sakya by one called Kunga Gyaltsen Palzangpo, a monk of the Śākya order.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

In the Indian language: Sarvajñamahāśvarastotra nāma.

In the Tibetan language: A Hymn to the Omniscient Great Lord.

I go for refuge to the one who is a god beyond the gods,
who is the guru of the gods,
and who has become the guru of gurus.

To the one who is great, who is sovereign,
who has become the Great Lord,
the Lord who is liberated from all three worlds —
to that Lord I bow in this very life.

By the light of wisdom-fire
the triple-tiered city whose nature is desire and delusion
is utterly burned and consumed —
to the Burner of the Three Cities I bow.

Always bearing the skull of loving-kindness,
anointed perfectly with the ash of compassion,
crowned upon the head with the moon of moral discipline —

to that Lord I bow in this very life.

Mounted upon the finest steed of the Great Vehicle,
possessed of the supreme horns of loving-kindness and compassion,
with the eyes of joy and equanimity —
that Great Lord who travels forth:

accompanied by the queens of generosity, moral discipline,
patience, diligence, meditative concentration and the rest,
along with the supreme consort —
to that Great Lord I bow.

Pervading all directions with the horns of deceit,
shattering afflictive existence from every side,
burning with blazing views the unbearable son of existence
who goes beyond —
whose heart possesses whatever the charnel ground requires,
who manifests in many and various emanated forms,
always embraced by his retinue —
to that Great Lord I bow.

Attended by those who pursue with desire the aims of all three worlds,
vanquishing those who seek their own purposes,
to whom those who accomplish his command do not depart —
to that Great Lord I bow.

Possessed of the eightfold discipline,
born from the egg of the feet of miraculous power,
the great fearless island surrounded on all sides,
whose very gate moves utterly pure,
through whom flows the river of compassion,
who holds the river of the holy Dharma —
to that Great Lord I bow.

Terrifying all the world with the buffalo of ignorance,
yet dispelling it with the three-pointed spear of gnosis —
the Great Lord who bears the three-pronged spear:
completely pure in the highest, lowest, and middle states,
whether pacified or unpackified,
the Great Lord who has fully liberated all that is unpeaceful —
to that Great Lord I bow.

To the one who by the distinction of supreme compassion
clearly snatches away all the sufferings of birth without exception —
to that Snatcher I bow.

To the sublime and glorious Lord,
who has abandoned craving for the waters of desire —
to that Great God (Śiva) I bow, the one who brings happiness to all sentient
beings.

To the one who, following after all beings,
gathers all sentient beings,
who cannot be overcome by the obstacles of māra,
who vanquishes desire —
to that one I bow.

To the great, sublime, and mighty Lord,
the one who arose piercing through terrible evil —
to that Great God I bow, the one who wishes benefit for all sentient beings.

To the one who is an enemy to all harm,
who is perfect even in loving-kindness and turns away,
and in whom the white dharmas are complete —
to that Lord I bow in this very life.

To the pacified one, who swiftly pacifies with a mere word
the beings afflicted by planetary influences and epidemic disease and poverty
and those tormented by karma —
to that Pacifier I bow.

By the merit I have accumulated through this praise
to the Lord of all the world,
may this entire world, leaving nothing out,
become a great lord of gnosis.

This Hymn called "To the Omniscient Great Lord" was composed by the
brahmin layman Mauntogṛhadeva. It was translated by the Indian paṇḍita
Jārandhana and the chief translator Rinchen Zangpo.

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with a colophon noting that a Sanskrit commentary could not be found, and that the Tibetan monk Kunga Gyaltzen Palzangpo therefore completed the work at Sakya monastery. This is a standard scribal colophon framing what follows.

The hymn is addressed to Śiva understood through a Buddhist interpretive lens — the epithets (Great God, Lord of all worlds, bearer of the skull, smeared with ash, bearer of the trident, the three-eyed one implied by the three-pronged spear) are all standard Śaiva imagery. The Buddhist reinterpretation systematically reads these Śaiva attributes as symbols of Mahāyāna virtues: the skull as loving-kindness, the ash as compassion, the moon as moral discipline, the trident as the threefold gnosis that destroys ignorance. This is a well-attested genre of Buddhist apologetic hymns to Śiva.

The phrase rendered "the buffalo of ignorance" renders the Tibetan བཤིཤ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, where ལྷ་མོ་ is a transliteration of Sanskrit mahiṣa, "buffalo" — the vehicle (vāhana) of Yama, here allegorized as ignorance.

The composer's name in the final colophon is given in Tibetan transcription as མངུ་ཏོག་མཛེས་པའི་ཆེན་པོ་, which appears to represent a Sanskrit name; the reconstruction "Mauntogṛhadeva" is tentative and genuinely uncertain. Some scholars read it differently.

The stanza beginning "Pervading all directions with the horns of deceit" is among the most difficult in the hymn. The imagery of རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ ("horns of deceit / wiles") applied to Śiva may refer to his supernatural power to bewitch, or may carry a positive valence in the Buddhist reinterpretation as skillful means. The passage as a whole is syntactically compressed and the rendering reflects the most coherent reading available.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.